

Executive AI Briefing

Plain-spoken AI orientation for leaders who need clarity before making budget, policy, vendor, or training decisions.

Format	One focused Zoom briefing, optionally followed by a Q&A; or planning session.
Level	Leadership level: clarity before technology decisions
Audience	Executives, founders, board-adjacent leaders, and department heads who need a useful map rather than hype.

Learner outcomes

- Separate AI training needs from software purchasing needs.
- Ask better questions about vendors, data, policy, implementation, and organizational readiness.
- Identify decisions that need more learning before investment.
- Leave with a leadership vocabulary for opportunity, uncertainty, human review, and responsible experimentation.

Guiding questions

- What should leaders understand before authorizing tools, pilots, policies, or budgets?
- Where does education need to come before procurement?
- Which risks require the right internal owners rather than a training promise?
- What small next step would increase clarity without locking the organization into a premature decision?

Readiness checks

- Leaders can explain why fluency training may be needed before tool investment.
- Leaders can ask practical questions about data boundaries, review, ownership, and expected value.
- The organization has named which decisions require internal policy, legal, privacy, or technical owners.
- The next step is small enough to learn from and clear enough to communicate.

Research-backed adoption practices

- Treat AI adoption as work redesign and capability building, not simply tool access.
- Ask what evidence would justify scaling before approving major spend or vendor lock-in.
- Align incentives, manager support, and evaluation habits so experimentation can produce shared learning.
- Create a basic evaluation structure: who reviews outputs, who updates workflows, and how lessons are captured.

Curriculum modules

What leaders need to know now

A clear map of current AI capabilities, limitations, tool categories, and common misconceptions.

Clarity before complexity

We distinguish fluency, workflow practice, policy, vendor evaluation, and implementation work.

Responsible decision questions

Leaders practice asking about data exposure, review requirements, accountability, and expected business value.

Next-step decision paths

The briefing ends with a recommendation for training, discovery, a small pilot, or a deliberate wait.

Internal communication

Leaders practice explaining AI next steps in language that reduces confusion, fear, and unrealistic expectations.

Session flow

Landscape

Explain current AI capabilities, limitations, and tool categories in plain language.

Separate

Distinguish fluency training, workflow practice, policy, vendor evaluation, implementation, and governance.

Question

Work through leader-level questions about value, data exposure, review burden, and accountability.

Decide

Sort likely next steps into train, discover, pilot, wait, or seek specialist advice.

Communicate

Draft a short internal message that frames AI learning without hype or guarantees.

Practice labs

Vendor question drill

Translate broad vendor claims into concrete questions about data handling, review, workflow fit, and training needs.

Decision-gate scenario

Walk through an AI idea and decide whether it belongs in training, discovery, pilot, procurement, or wait.

Risk language rehearsal

Practice naming uncertainty and boundaries without implying legal, medical, compliance, or cybersecurity guarantees.

Leadership message draft

Create a calm message that explains why the organization is learning before buying or implementing.

1-2 hour utility projects

These short projects are designed to help individuals experience practical AI utility while keeping inputs safe and human review visible.

How to choose a strong first project

- Real work, low risk: choose a task people already recognize, but keep inputs public, fictional, or sanitized.
- Clear walk-away artifact: produce a brief, agenda, checklist, glossary, comparison table, or reusable prompt sequence.
- Visible judgment step: check claims, name uncertainty, revise tone, or decide what should remain human-led.
- Transferable habit: practice a pattern the learner can reuse later, such as giving context, comparing outputs, or verifying before relying.

Learning Sprint (60-75 minutes)

Turn a confusing topic into a private tutor session.

Walk-away artifact: A one-page explainer, a short quiz, a glossary, and a list of what to verify elsewhere.

Safe input: Use a public topic, a public article, or a concept you want to understand. Avoid private client, patient, employee, or proprietary material.

- Ask for a plain-language explanation at your current level.
- Request examples, analogies, common misconceptions, and a five-question quiz.

- Ask what claims need source checking before you rely on them.

Starter prompt: Teach me [topic] as a smart beginner. Start with a plain-language explanation, then give examples, common misconceptions, a short glossary, a five-question quiz, and a list of claims I should verify with reliable sources.

Decision Clarity Brief (75-90 minutes)

Use AI to make a decision easier to think about without outsourcing the decision.

Walk-away artifact: A comparison table, assumptions list, pre-mortem, missing-information checklist, and final decision questions.

Safe input: Use a personal, public, fictional, or sanitized decision. Keep confidential finances, contracts, medical, legal, or customer details out of public tools.

- Describe the options, constraints, values, and what would count as success.
- Ask AI to compare options and surface assumptions instead of choosing for you.
- Run a pre-mortem and identify what a human should check before acting.

Starter prompt: Help me think through this decision without deciding for me: [safe decision context]. Create criteria, compare options, name assumptions, run a pre-mortem, list missing information, and end with questions I should answer myself.

Meeting Prep Kit (60-90 minutes)

Turn a rough meeting idea into a more useful conversation.

Walk-away artifact: A meeting agenda, prep questions, likely tensions, decision points, and a follow-up email template.

Safe input: Use fictional or sanitized meeting context. Do not paste private attendee notes, personnel details, patient data, customer records, or proprietary plans into public tools.

- Give AI the purpose, audience, desired outcome, and any safe background.
- Ask for an agenda, questions, risks, and decisions to clarify.
- Revise the agenda for tone, time, and who needs to review it.

Starter prompt: Using this fictional or sanitized meeting context, create a focused agenda, prep questions, likely tensions, decision points, and a follow-up email template. Mark anything that needs human confirmation: [context].

Writing Upgrade Studio (60 minutes)

See how AI can draft, critique, and revise with you in a loop.

Walk-away artifact: A stronger email, memo, bio, announcement, or short article with a revision history and review checklist.

Safe input: Use a rough draft that contains no sensitive personal, client, patient, employee, legal, financial, or proprietary details.

- Ask for a first rewrite for a specific audience and tone.
- Ask AI to critique its own draft for clarity, claims, tone, and missing context.
- Request a final revision and make the last edits yourself.

Starter prompt: Improve this rough draft for [audience] with a [tone] tone. Then critique your revision for clarity, unsupported claims, missing context, and anything a human should verify before sending: [safe draft].

Research Compass (90-120 minutes)

Use AI to plan research before you read, search, or cite.

Walk-away artifact: A research question map, search terms, source categories, red flags, and verification plan.

Safe input: Use a public topic or general business question. Do not ask AI to invent citations or make final claims without sources.

- Ask AI to turn a broad topic into better questions and search terms.
- Request source categories, possible biases, and missing perspectives.
- Use the output as a reading plan, then verify claims in actual sources.

Starter prompt: Help me plan research on [public topic]. Create key questions, search terms, source types to seek, likely blind spots, red flags, and a verification checklist. Do not make final claims without sources.

Workflow Recipe Builder (90-120 minutes)

Turn one repeated task into a reusable AI-assisted workflow.

Walk-away artifact: A workflow recipe with inputs, prompt sequence, review gates, human owner, and when-not-to-use guidance.

Safe input: Choose a recurring task and describe it generally or with fictional examples. Keep sensitive operational data out of public tools.

- Map the task into steps, inputs, outputs, review points, and handoffs.
- Ask AI where it can help and where human judgment should stay in charge.
- Create a repeatable prompt sequence and a review checklist.

Starter prompt: Turn this recurring task into a safe AI-assisted workflow recipe: [task]. Include purpose, safe inputs, prompt sequence, review checkpoints, human decision points, risks, and when not to use AI for this task.

Professional Profile Refresh (75-90 minutes)

Use AI as a coach for describing your work more clearly.

Walk-away artifact: A refreshed bio, resume bullet options, interview talking points, and confidence-building practice questions.

Safe input: Use a sanitized career summary or fictionalized role description. Do not include private employer data, references, compensation, or confidential projects.

- Give AI a safe summary of your work, audience, and desired tone.
- Ask for clearer positioning, bullet options, and examples of evidence to add.
- Roleplay interview questions and revise anything that feels inflated or inaccurate.

Starter prompt: Using this sanitized professional summary, help me describe my work more clearly. Draft a short bio, five resume bullet options, three interview talking points, and questions I should answer to make the claims more accurate: [summary].

Personal Planning Co-Pilot (60-75 minutes)

Use AI to turn vague goals into a realistic plan you can actually follow.

Walk-away artifact: A one-week plan, prioritized task list, obstacle plan, review ritual, and next-action checklist.

Safe input: Use personal goals and constraints that are not private, medical, financial, legal, or deeply sensitive.

- Describe the goal, constraints, time available, and what has made it hard.
- Ask AI for a practical plan with tradeoffs and small next actions.
- Review the plan yourself and remove anything unrealistic or intrusive.

Starter prompt: Help me turn this goal into a realistic one-week plan: [safe goal]. Ask clarifying questions if needed, then create priorities, daily actions, likely obstacles, a review ritual, and a simple checklist.

Tangible cases

Vendor pitch review

Situation: A CEO hears a vendor promise broad productivity gains and wants better questions before spending money.

Learner task: Translate the pitch into concrete questions about workflow fit, data handling, review, ownership, and training.

Starter prompt: Turn this vendor claim into practical evaluation questions. Cover workflow fit, data handling, human review, implementation burden, training needs, lock-in, and evidence we should request: [vendor claim].

Board-level AI stance

Situation: A board or senior leadership group asks whether the organization has an AI strategy.

Learner task: Draft a calm response that frames learning, boundaries, and next steps without overpromising outcomes.

Starter prompt: Draft a board-level AI learning statement. Emphasize clarity before complexity, staff fluency, safe experimentation, human judgment, and decisions that need the right internal owners. Avoid hype and guarantees.

Policy before practice tension

Situation: A department wants to ban, buy, or standardize AI before staff understand practical use.

Learner task: Separate what training can solve from what requires policy, legal, privacy, technical, or procurement decisions.

Starter prompt: Given this leadership concern, separate issues into fluency training, workflow practice, policy, procurement, technical implementation, and specialist review. Recommend a small next step for each: [concern].

Prompt library

Decision gate

Evaluate this AI idea through decision gates: learn, practice, pilot, buy, wait, or seek specialist review. Explain the evidence needed before moving to the next gate: [AI idea].

Leadership briefing prep

Prepare a plain-language executive briefing on [AI topic]. Include what it is, what it is useful for, limits, risks, good questions to ask, and a cautious next step.

Vendor question bank

Create a vendor question bank for [tool category]. Include questions about data use, privacy, review workflows, admin controls, implementation effort, training, support, and exit options.

Internal message

Draft an internal message explaining that we are learning about AI before making major technology decisions. Keep it calm, practical, nontechnical, and clear about responsible use boundaries.

Materials to develop

- Executive briefing deck outline
- Vendor question guide
- AI investment readiness checklist
- Train, pilot, buy, or wait worksheet
- Leadership communication template

- Decision-gate question bank

Diagram candidates

These are intentionally left as candidate visuals until diagram parameters are chosen.

- Decision gates for AI investment
- Build, buy, train, or wait decision tree
- Leadership clarity map: learn, test, decide, communicate
- Responsible adoption operating model: people, process, governance, measurement

Follow-up work

- Select a first audience for training or discovery.
- List vendor, policy, or data questions that require specialist review.
- Schedule a follow-up briefing or readiness sprint if the organization needs a fuller map.

Session design reminders

- Keep examples non-sensitive and realistic.
- Emphasize education, judgment, review, and careful experimentation.
- Do not promise legal, medical, compliance, cybersecurity, or automation outcomes.
- Name when a stronger tool, private environment, or policy decision is needed before proceeding.

API and tool boundary

This curriculum companion does not require an API call. Any secure password protection, private client portal, or live AI workflow exercise that transmits data to an external model should be reviewed before implementation.